

THEGAPBRIEF · SIDE REPORT · OCTOBER 13, 2026

AI Influencer Trends, Sep–Oct 2026: What CharacterGuard Ads Can Ride

What's blowing up in AI influencers on Instagram, TikTok and X (Sep 13 – Oct 13, 2026): niches, hooks, tools, fastest-growing accounts, the copycat problem, and where CharacterGuard ads fit.

Assigned by Jacob Peterson · OMI Companies · CharacterGuard. X figures are public post counts as of Oct 13, 2026. Every claim links to its source; numbers appear only where a cited source states them.

NICHES 1. Niches blowing up

1.1 Uncanny "signature look" characters (comedy/lifestyle)

Jean Philanthrope launched Sep 17. UNILAD reports 240K Instagram and 267.7K TikTok followers.

uniladtech.com

1.2 Luxury lifestyle

@charles.robinson62 (barefoot guy stepping out of Lamborghinis) had 948K Instagram followers by Oct 11, and his top video has 99.6M views (JARRUS).

thejarrus.com

1.3 AI "stand-up comedy"

Tiffany Sloane (@tiffany.bbyx) reached 375K+ followers between Sep 11 and early October, per Kotaku as relayed by SLOP TV. Her posts were wiped by Oct 10.

sloptvnews.com

1.4 Beauty

The strongest in-window brand example is a recurring mascot. Depuff AI's cat-girl "Luna" gives glow-up tips first and pitches second (Lightreel, Oct 3–10 window).

lightreel.ai

1.5 Fashion / VTubers

The X VORDER RUNWAY VTuber fashion show was held at Makuhari Messe on Sep 27. Jean Phil's Paris Fashion Week post tagged Stella McCartney, though that doesn't prove a sponsorship (UNILAD, link above).

alive-project.com

1.6 Travel

Cinematic AI-influencer travel stories, e.g. this X post at about 31.5K impressions.

x.com

1.7 Fitness

No strong breakout turned up in this window. The closest example is older: Hololive VTuber Yukihana Lamy × chocoZAP gyms, May 13 – Jul 12, 2026.

moguravr.com

1.8 Meme-coin tie-ins

These characters increasingly launch tokens ($JEANPHIL, $CHARLES), so the persona doubles as a brand asset (UNILAD and JARRUS, links above).

FORMATS & HOOKS

2. Formats and hooks

2.1 "Your character in any viral trend"

Motion transfer onto a known clip. Higgsfield's AI Influencer tool relaunched Oct 2, built on Genjutsu (launched Sep 1).

thejarrus.com

2.2 One or two photos turned into a meme template

Rumpelstiltskin "tip toeing", Burning Bridges, the Zombie "CHOICE" short, Raindance and Alors on danse. Two-person templates are the new default (PoloX, Oct 9).

polox.ai

2.3 Side-by-side "real input vs. AI output" proof

The strongest reusable format in Lightreel's Oct 3–10 review.

lightreel.ai

2.4 Episodic virtual casts and recurring mascots

Beat one-off talking-head avatars (Lightreel, above).

2.5 Faceless, atmosphere-first AI influencer clips

"millions of views without showing her face" (a creator's claim, not independently verified).

x.com

2.6 Keyword-comment CTAs

("Comment CLONE/ACCESS") are everywhere in AI-influencer promo posts.

x.com

2.7 Disclosure as a hook

Instagram's "AI-generated profile" label (since Aug 31); unlabeled profiles may lose recommendations.

gensoai.io

TOOLS 3. Tools creators use

3.1 Higgsfield

(AI Influencer + Genjutsu): it dominates Instagram AI-character content, and Charles Robinson's account is a Higgsfield "Creative Partner".

thejarrus.com

3.2 X promos of Higgsfield's AI Influencer tool

@MayorKingAI's post had about 9.3K impressions. A UGC-retainer playbook by @jacobrodri_ had about 4.2K.

x.com · x.com

3.3 Nano Banana (character sheets) + Seedance 2.5 (reference video)

The "make a Jean Phil-style influencer" workflow (Oct 10).

tech4ssd.com

3.4 Kling 3 now, Kling 4.0 announced Sep 28

For an October release. Used for multi-scene character consistency.

kavel.ai

3.5 APOB AI + Seedance 2.5

For consistent-character stories: about 30.7K impressions on X.

x.com

3.6 Others

Runway, CapCut templates, Arcads (Nano-Banana 2 + Replace Actor), HeyGen clones, ElevenLabs V4, Veo/Flow (Lightreel).

lightreel.ai

3.7 Vidrush Persona

("AI influencer channel in 60 minutes"): about 6.6K impressions.

x.com

FASTEST-GROWING 4. Fastest-growing accounts (only where a source gives numbers)

4.1 @charles.robinson62

@charles.robinson62: took off in the first week of October and reached 948K Instagram followers by Oct 11 (JARRUS).

thejarrus.com

4.2 @jean_philanthrope

@jean_philanthrope: first post Sep 17, now 240K on Instagram and 267.7K on TikTok (UNILAD, Oct 8).

uniladtech.com

4.3 @tiffany.bbyx

@tiffany.bbyx: 375K+ followers in under a month, then wiped (Kotaku via SLOP TV).

sloptvnews.com

4.4 Copycats

Copycats: "Jeanne Philanthrope" reached 147.6K and "Jeanne Misanthrope" 21K in days (UNILAD, above).

4.5 Most new personas go nowhere. Lightreel cites @heyitsnova.ai at 956 fo

Most new personas go nowhere. Lightreel cites @heyitsnova.ai at 956 followers and a median of 175 views.

lightreel.ai

4.6 No platform-wide growth leaderboard is public. Beyond these sourced sn

No platform-wide growth leaderboard is public. Beyond these sourced snapshots, there's no growth data.

COPYCATS & CLONES

5. Copycats, clones, stolen faces: yes, this is a live topic

5.1 Jean Phil copycats claim to be the original

Jean Phil copycats claim to be the original, and UNILAD says operators are "launching dozens of copycats every day".

uniladtech.com

5.2 Comics Olivia Carter

Comics Olivia Carter, Sarah Purdum and George Brett Olson say an AI persona lifted their sets to funnel viewers to paid pages. Olson posted a side-by-side on Oct 3.

fanslist.com

5.3 The Guardian

The Guardian (Sep 12) covered creators deepfaked into fake ads: Emily Schuman in GLP-1 and makeup ads, and Arielle Lorre in a skincare ad. Takedowns took weeks or didn't happen.

theguardian.com

5.4 On X

On X, a user says a site "stole my face" to make AI videos of them.

x.com

5.5 Creator-safety guides now cover face-swap clones and fake accounts

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creatortraffic.com

5.6 PoloX warns that trend templates bury original creators and carry obvi

PoloX warns that trend templates bury original creators and carry obvious likeness risk.

polox.ai

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5 TRENDS TO RIDE — Top 5 trends CharacterGuard ads can ride

6.1 Viral character, instant clones

The Jean Phil copycat wave. A hit character now gets cloned within days.

6.2 Signature-look personas

A mustache, a suit, a barefoot billionaire. Distinctive looks are exactly what's worth protecting by name and face.

6.3 "Put your character in any trend" motion transfer

(Higgsfield Genjutsu, Seedance reference mode). The same tools let anyone drop *your* character into *their* clip.

6.4 Side-by-side proof videos

Audiences already reward real-vs-AI split screens and creator callouts (Olson's Oct 3 side-by-side).

6.5 AI labels and disclosure

Instagram's AI-generated profile label and TikTok's AI labels make "verified original" a credible, timely message.

TOOLS — 3 ad ideas

7.1 "Spot the original" (split-screen, 9:16, about 15 s)

Four near-identical versions of a fictional CharacterGuard demo character (never a real third party's character). Hook: "Your AI influencer went viral. So did these 4." Cut to a PromptPatrol face-watch scan flagging the lookalikes. End card: "Free name-conflict check at characterguard.com."

7.2 "Drop me into any trend… wait, not that one" (motion-transfer skit)

The demo character joins a trend template, then finds a clone running the same trend with a different handle. Voiceover: "Same tools that made you famous can copy you by Friday. Lock your name, watch your face." CTA: the $299 Starter (Lock kit + PromptPatrol).

7.3 "Receipts" (creator-callout format)

Mirrors the comedian side-by-side. The creator holds up a dated CharacterGuard Lock record beside a copycat clip: "I don't argue, I show the timestamp." Carousel variant: Day 1 viral, Day 3 copycat, Day 4 flagged, Day 5 takedown filed.

Ad caution: don't use Jean Phil, Charles Robinson or other real accounts' likenesses in ads, and label any AI footage. Don't promise takedowns or approvals; say "watch, flag and document."

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